

“My engagement with open source started with contributions to Mozilla Firefox, which was an achievement for me”

Mayank Raj, Lead Member of Technical Staff, Salesforce, believes that companies entering the open source arena can gain by building on existing projects and collaborating with the community. In a candid conversation with *OSFY's Yashasvini Razdan*, he reveals how Salesforce is finding a balance between internal and open source development.

Q. What is the incentive for developers to contribute to open source projects?

There are certain people who like to commit to multiple projects through open source, which wouldn't be possible if they were working on just one project at a company. The community is so energised with these contributions that it provides a great entryway for newcomers to enter the development community. My engagement with open source started with contributions to Mozilla Firefox, which was an achievement for me. When I saw someone using Firefox, I could say, “Hey! The browser that you are using has a code written by me.” It's a point of pride, and it allowed me to interact with industry veterans, something I wouldn't have been able to do otherwise.

Q. What is Salesforce's engagement with open source?

Salesforce has a dedicated office of open source, led by a former leader

Mayank Raj,
Lead Member of
Technical Staff, Salesforce



from the Apache Foundation. This team ensures that Salesforce personnel invest sufficient time in contributing to open source projects. While we develop solutions that can be limited to internal use for various reasons, there is always a healthy discussion of trying to understand if the solution can be generalised enough for the wider ecosystem.

We actively leverage and contribute to the open source ecosystem. I work with a team that is one of the major contributors to the open source application service mesh projects. Salesforce has developed a significant monitoring tool initially intended for internal use but has since been made open source and is widely used, with

considerable contributions from the community. We have various projects in the AI domain that are being worked on along with the community.

Q. Does Salesforce also follow inner sourcing?

Yes, we do actively engage in inner sourcing. If a team needs to develop a project and feels individuals from other teams can also collaborate on it, it can post this requirement on internal tools and communication channels. In these posts, the nature of the work, the estimated time needed, and the profile of the individual being sought for the task are detailed. This approach encourages collaboration among